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(AI-Generated Session Notes)

AI-Driven Content Performance Monitoring: Continuous Tracking, Smart Alerts and Proactive Reporting

Date & time: Oct. 14, 11:40 AM-12:15 PM EST
Track: Applied AI



Dale Bertrand
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Session Description

Stop reacting to content performance issues that already cost you customers. Start preventing them before they impact revenue. Most content and SEO teams operate reactively—pulling last week's data, discovering yesterday's traffic drops, and explaining performance losses after they've already happened. Start proactively identifying opportunities. Join AI and SEO veteran Dale Bertrand as he demonstrates how to break free from reactive reporting, build proactive monitoring systems, and start identifying threats and opportunities in real time. You'll leave with practical AI workflows that detect issues early, prevent losses, and prove productivity gains executives understand.

Key Quote

> *"It's not about what it knows anymore. It's what it can do for you because we're going to give it all the context."* **- Dale Bertrand**

Session Summary

Dale Bertrand, President of Fire&Spark, an SEO agency focused on AI search optimization, opened with a story about his daughter's lemonade stand. She earned enough for a Nintendo Switch because she noticed, in real time, that payments had shifted from dollar bills to $20s once a neighbor started inviting people over, and she joined him. Bertrand used the story to frame the session: content performance monitoring with AI is about watching the right signals as they happen.

He argued that monitoring has to scale because buying journeys have changed. Buyers now start their research on AI platforms and then turn to branded searches, so brands need to track their entire footprint: their own website and social channels, customer reviews and case studies, market conversations, trade media and analysts, and what competitors are saying.

A major theme was enriching AI reporting with a custom industry taxonomy. Using his agency's healthcare practice as the example, Bertrand had AI scrape 400 healthcare websites, extract the

services they offer, and generalize the attributes used to describe them, such as conditions treated, symptoms, care model, insurance coverage and pricing, mapped to schema.org entities. An audit of SonderMind's site then flagged that its military therapy service was missing information like the conditions it treats, clinician credentials and outcome claims, which AI search engines need in order to know when to recommend it. He packages each workflow as a reusable skill.

Bertrand also challenged the habit of monthly reporting, which he said exists because humans do it, and urged teams to list the questions they need answered and assign each one a real-time, weekly, monthly or quarterly cadence. He described two shifts in AI: it is now used to act on the context and data you provide rather than to know things, and new decision AI models classify data and answer yes/no questions with a confidence score instead of generating text. His pipeline pulls pages from the sitemap, gathers Search Console and GA4 data, sends it to a decision model with a long list of questions, and then has a large language model write the report. He said an audit of all 500 pages on his site costs about five cents, so he runs it every hour.

He closed on anomaly detection, crediting Christopher Penn for the approach: compare a short rolling average of three to seven days against a longer 28-day average so normal swings, like weekend dips, are ignored while genuine deviations trigger an immediate alert. Sensitivity can be tuned through the deviation threshold, how many days an anomaly must persist, and its magnitude, and he noted that every system will over-alert at first and always needs tuning.

Key Takeaways

- **Watch the right signals in real time.** Waiting for monthly reports means learning about problems, like a page blocked from Google, long after the damage is done.
- **Teach AI your industry.** A custom taxonomy of the products or services you offer and their attributes makes AI-generated audits and reports far smarter than generic ones.
- **Match each question to a cadence.** List the questions your reporting must answer and decide which need instant alerts, which are weekly and which are monthly or quarterly.
- **Use decision AI for classification.** Decision models label pages and answer yes/no questions much faster and more cheaply than LLMs, which can then write up the findings.
- **Always be building a skill.** Turn each workflow, from building a taxonomy to running an audit, into a reusable skill so you never have to rebuild it.
- **Tune your anomaly alerts.** Compare short-term averages to a 28-day baseline and adjust the threshold, persistence and magnitude so alerts flag only meaningful changes.